



Netflix's The Witcher

Netflix's 'The Witcher' Series details and full casting information is potentially revealed on reddit. <https://dgit.in/feb19-65>



Cigarette filters pollute

Plastic straws and bags have received widespread attention as pollutants. However, cigarette filters could be worse. <https://dgit.in/feb19-66>

with Uber in developing flying taxi prototypes. Airbus had also successfully completed their test flight on the Vahana last year. Several other companies have already joined the bandwagon of building the next flying car and it looks like the next couple of years are finally going to bring it to reality. When it does become one, we are glad that we won't be dealing with the ugly headgear worn by the cops shown in the movie.

VIDEO CALLING

If the future unfolded according to Blade Runner, you'd be video calling your friends or family from video calling booths. Pay phones or phone booths were a thing back then and it's natural to think of the next innovation to be video calling based on the same foundation. Considering the creators were able to predict video calls in the future, it's fascinating how they weren't able to foresee smartphones. You won't find any cell phones in the movie at all. We believe the possibility of smartphones wasn't explored because of the direction the development of display screens were headed when the movie was made. The depiction of television sets are a big giveaway on why they failed to perceive that. All of them are CRT displays, so they are enclosed in boxes. Clearly, no one thought that we would have super thin LED displays in 2019.

MASSIVE DIGITAL BILLBOARDS

This is another technological aspect depicted in Blade Runner that has now become synonymous with the cyberpunk genre of sci-fi. Larger than life digital billboards cover the entirety of skyscrapers while flying cars whizz past them. Although we haven't reached the scale of advertisement as shown in the movie, we have certainly implemented the same at several locations. The best example would be Times Square where there are an overwhelming number of digital billboards. As for ads on skyscrapers, the Burj Khalifa already does that with the gigantic 33,000 square foot



LED screen all around it. Coca-Cola is widely seen on the billboards throughout the movie. This is another prediction that actually came true since the beverage company is still standing strong and we do see them covering huge digital billboards. Coming back to digital ads, our present is already a step forward. Not just Google but other companies are experimenting to track users looking at billboards and serve them targeted ads.

ARTIFICIAL ANIMALS AND BIRDS

When Deckard visits Tyrell, he comes across an owl and immediately asks whether it's real. He learns that the bird is artificial, obviously. Later on, we also get to see an artificial snake. This means creating artificial animals and birds has been accomplished. It shouldn't be a surprise, since they were already successful in creating the replicants. If human level intelligence in replicants was achievable, animal intelligence should be fairly simpler to recreate. The city already looks bleak with tall buildings and massive factories spanning the horizon. It's not difficult to believe that we've probably managed to drive the majority of the species of animals and birds to extinction, if not all of them. Coming to the current scenario, we haven't reached the extinction of species to such a critical point on the planet, yet. However, we have already entered the sixth mass extinction of the planet and several species are going extinct at an



alarming rate. Naturally, about one to five species go extinct every year but scientists are estimating that the decline is about 1,000 to 10,000 times the natural rate. If this continues, then by 2050, almost 30 to 50 percent of all the species will be extinct.

INTERGALACTIC COLONIES

In the opening sequence, we see ads from offworld colonies promising a wonderful life away from Earth. Space colonisation was another natural progression seen after space travel was conceived and achieved after landing on the moon. Travelling through the cosmos and inhabiting another planet has also been a central theme to sci-fi stories for ages. The climate in Blade Runner looks terrible and that's probably one of the biggest factor that might have fuelled the need for space colonies. However, we haven't even colonised the closest celestial body, the moon. Nor have we been able to send humans to Mars yet. The upcoming human missions to Mars are being



planned by NASA and Elon Musk's SpaceX with a timeframe of around 2024 in mind. Jeff Bezos' Blue Origin space company plans on establishing colonies on the moon by 2023. Eventually, we'll move on to building colonies on Mars. The extent of space travel and colonisation in the movie is massive (having reached the star of Orion) and achieving the same in real life is going to take several decades if not an entire century. This means spacecrafts and rockets capable of travelling at high speeds and sustaining life over vast intergalactic distances have been developed. As mentioned, this has been a central theme in science fiction for quite a while, but in real life, we're just taking baby steps in this direction. 